at our meeting place and found our bus going up in flames, the target of a fire bombing.

While this was going on, Guild officers continued to meet with strike leaders in the CSU to see if we could help bring about a reasonable settlement. The meetings went on for months on an almost daily basis.

Some days I'd go home after hours of negotiations and think we'd made some progress toward a settlement. But the next morning we'd meet again and the strikers would walk into the room with their lawyers and twenty-seven new demands we'd never discussed before, which they said had to be settled before they'd call off the strike.

In the end, we beat 'em. The strike collapsed in February 1947. The decision by the Guild and several other unions to ignore the picket lines ultimately destroyed not only the strike but the Conference of Studio Unions.

Later, several members of the Communist Party in Hollywood who had been involved in the attempted takeover went public and described in intimate detail how Moscow was trying to take over the picture business. The California Senate Fact-Finding Committee on Un-American Activities, after a lengthy inquiry, confirmed that the strike was part of a Soviet effort to gain control over Hollywood and the content of its films. Although the principal leader of the strike told Congress that he had never been a Communist, investigators produced evidence that they said proved he was a secret member of the party, and a year later, national leaders of his union concluded he had "willfully and knowingly associated with groups subservient to the Communist Party."

American movies occupied seventy percent of all the playing time on the world's movie screens in those first years after World War II, and, as was to become more and more apparent to me, Joseph Stalin had set out to make